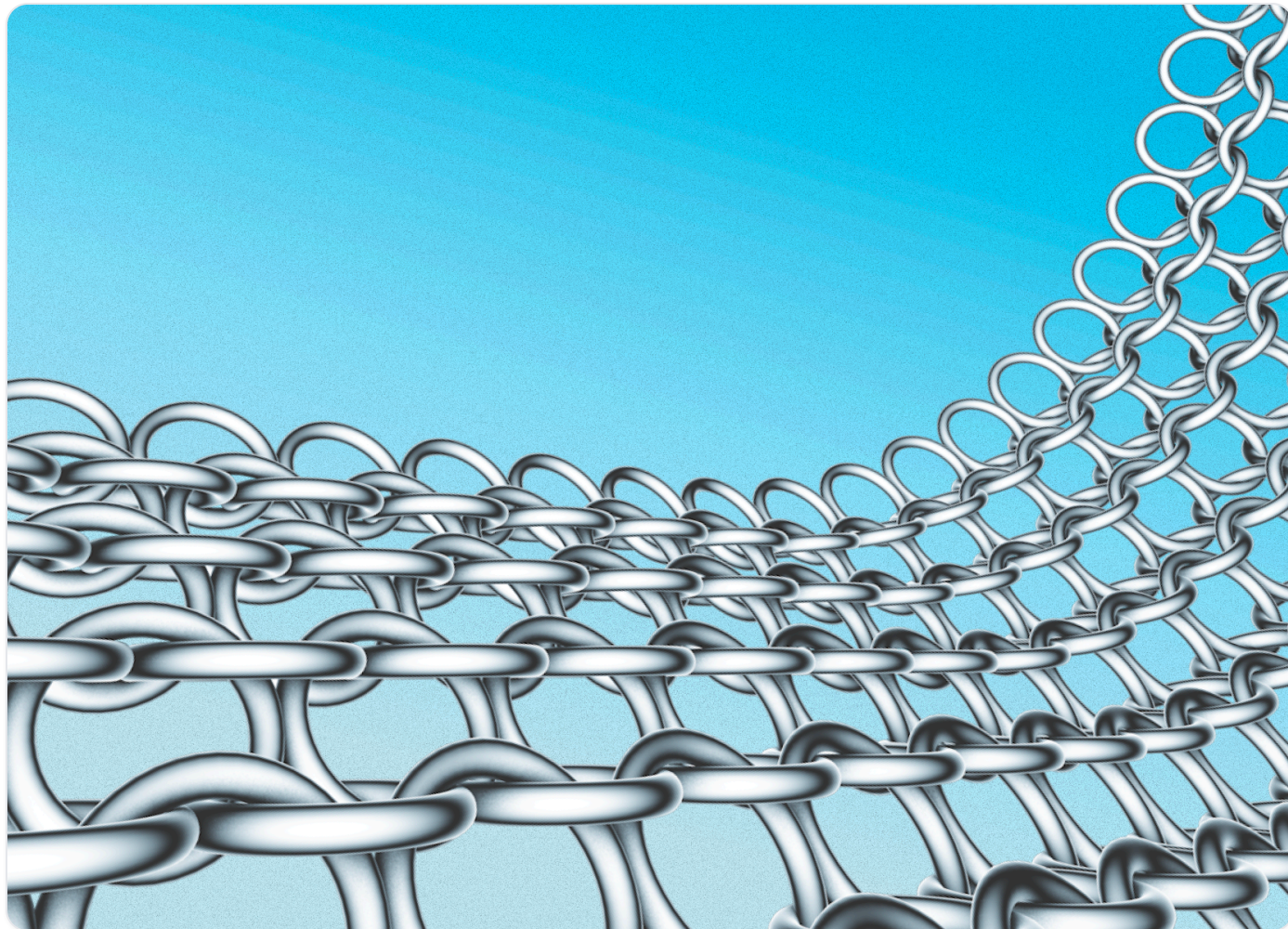




Q3 2026 Membership Audit

August 26, 2026

Our membership has concluded its latest quarterly audit of funded members as of August 5, 2026. This, our 17th consecutive update reaffirms our institution's consistency and ability to self-regulate.

The member registry now includes a number of new contributor accounts as well as new alumni; creating a representative body of the developers and

maintainers who work on client implementations, research, and upgrade delivery.

Protocol Guild's membership is now 190, with a net decrease of 6 (-3.1%) members from 196 of last quarter. This quarter, the membership update was once again processed onchain via Protocol Guild's Agora-based DAO contracts. Readers will find a comprehensive list of the changeset below.

New Members (9 total)

Working Group	New Member	Summary
Protocol Consensus	Ben Edgington <u>#526</u>	Returning Protocol Guild member (originally 2018-2024), rejoined in January 2026 to facilitate the development and delivery of fast finality to Ethereum. Recent work is showcased in the "Upgrading Finality" series on the Ethereum Foundation's blog.
zkEVM	Francesco Risitano <u>#524</u>	Joined EF Research Engineering's zkEVM project in January 2026. Co-championed and co-authored EIP-8025 (Optional Execution Proofs), driving the consensus side including the Lighthouse implementation, and co-authored EIP-8142 (Block-in-Blobs) and EIP-8331.
Protocol Security	Huaifeng Zhang <u>#510</u>	Joined EF Protocol Security in January 2026, applying AI tooling to Ethereum client auditing. Built an AI-assisted EIP/client auditing workflow that has surfaced issues acknowledged by client teams, along with benchmarking infrastructure for AI security tools.
Nimbus	Sam Shum <u>#521</u>	Contributing to Nimbus since March 2025, with work spanning Fulu column syncing, reconstruction, and recovery, and Gloas ePBS

Working Group	New Member	Summary
		syncing, envelope, and column handling. Instrumental in Nimbus's Glamsterdam devnet preparation and ongoing spec coordination.
Nimbus	Caleb <u>#508</u>	Developing ePBS and Gloas since November 2025, beginning as an EPF fellow before ePBS became the basis for Gloas. Engaged consistently on devnet coordination, spec development, and Nimbus's ePBS/Gloas design, implementation, and testing.
Nethermind	Daniil Ankushin <u>#517</u>	Contributing to Nethermind since November 2025, building State Benchmarks research that measures execution-layer performance up to 10x mainnet state to inform Glamsterdam gas-limit and Hegota statelessness decisions. Built the project's core client-side benchmarking infrastructure.
Nethermind	Stavros Vlachakis <u>#516</u>	Joined Nethermind in March 2025, full-time on the Core team since February 2026 with 100+ merged PRs. Owns Nethermind's JSON-RPC and implemented the EIP-4444 EraE archive format, RPC response streaming, and EVM performance optimizations.
Reth	Emma Jamieson-Hoare <u>#509</u>	Part-time Reth contributor since January 2026, representing Reth on ACDE, ACDT, and benchmarking calls. Maintains Reth's benchmark infrastructure and regression visibility, and manages Reth's releases and release notes.
Reth	Sergei Shulepov <u>#507</u>	Part-time Reth contributor since January 2026, working on Block Access Lists (BALs), MPT performance, and benchmarking infrastructure.

New Alumni Members (15 Total)

Protocol Guild members who move on to other work are considered 'Alumni' at the conclusion of their membership. We are grateful for their stewarding contributions to the world computer over the years and wish them well.

Working Group	New Alumni
Protocol Security	Andres Jimenez Lainez <u>#514</u> , Tyler Holmes <u>#531</u>
Protocol Prototyping	CarlBeek <u>#513</u> , Bharath Vedartham <u>#504</u>
P2P Networking	Marco <u>#511</u>
Nethermind	Ahmad Bitar <u>#506</u>
Geth	Jared Wasinger <u>#505</u> , Sina Mahmoodi <u>#503</u>
ETHPandaOps	Matty Evans <u>#502</u>
Protocol Architecture	Barnabe Monnot <u>#498</u>
Consensus Layer Specs + Coordination	Tim Beiko <u>#497</u>
Robust Incentive Group (RIG)	Julian Ma <u>#520</u>
STEEL	Keri Clowes <u>#522</u>
Independent / Uncategorized	Josh Rudolf <u>#519</u>
PG Operations + Funding	Peter Vecchiarelli <u>#532</u>

The next audit will begin in October 2026 and should be fully reflected in our active membership by mid-November.



PROTOCOL GUILD

